

STATE REVIEW LEARNINGS:

UNIVERSITY OF THE OZARKS

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

On-Site Review: October 8-9, 2024

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, "Candidate Recruitment and Completion," is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, "Preparing Candidates Effectively," criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, "Supporting Workforce Needs," are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

UNIVERSITY OF THE OZARKS

TRADITIONAL ROUTE

Overall Performance Level		
MEETS		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS

STANDARD 1: RECRUITMENT & COMPLETION

Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	APPROACHING	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
University of the Ozark's EPP has grown its enrollment well beyond the state target and effectively supports its students to complete the program. Focusing on increasing the percentage of candidates in high-need certification areas in proportion to the need would improve the EPP's Standard 1 rating.		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The University of the Ozarks' Annual Plan presents an impressive amount of evidence of action toward meeting framework indicators.

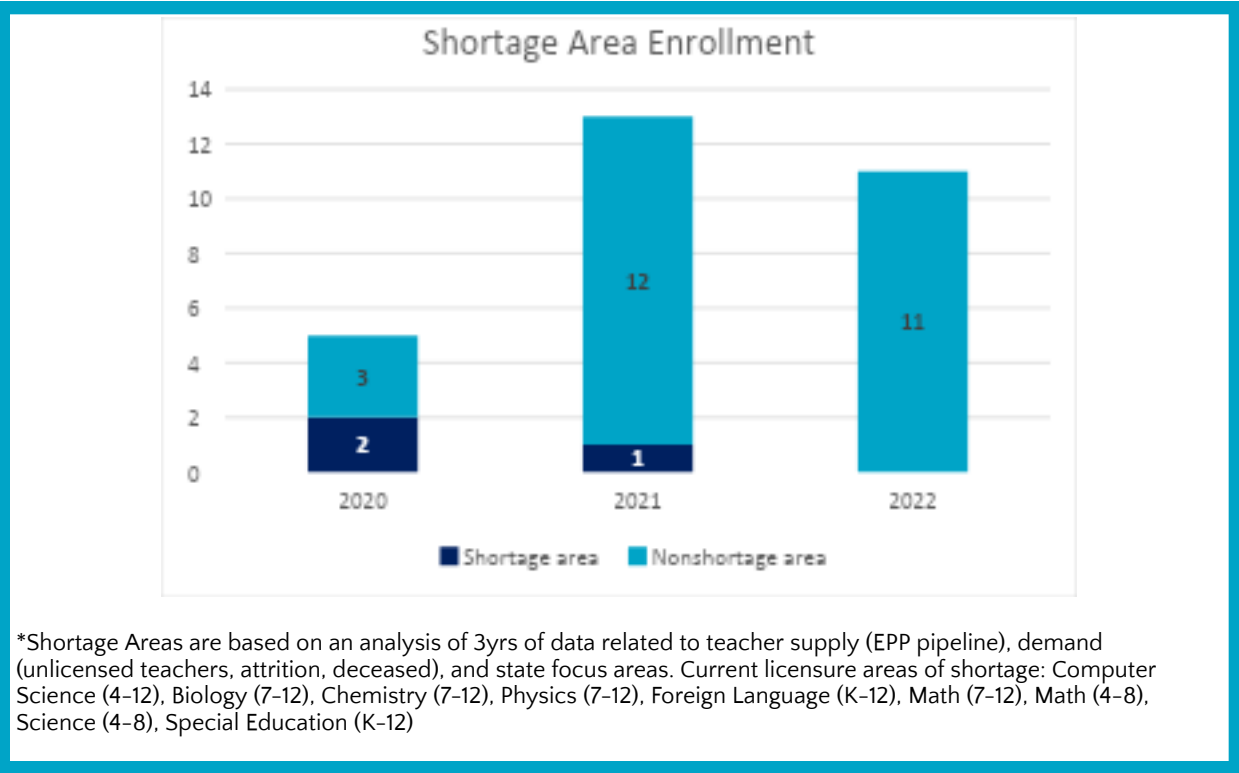
INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT

Criteria 1.2a: Programs meet annual recruitment targets that align with their program size and Arkansas's workforce needs			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Growth in 3yr Average Enrollment	Performance Level
Percentage growth in 3yr average enrollment	10%	31.8%	EXCEEDS

Year	Percentage Growth
2017	3
2018	14
2019	5
2020	5
2021	13
2022	11

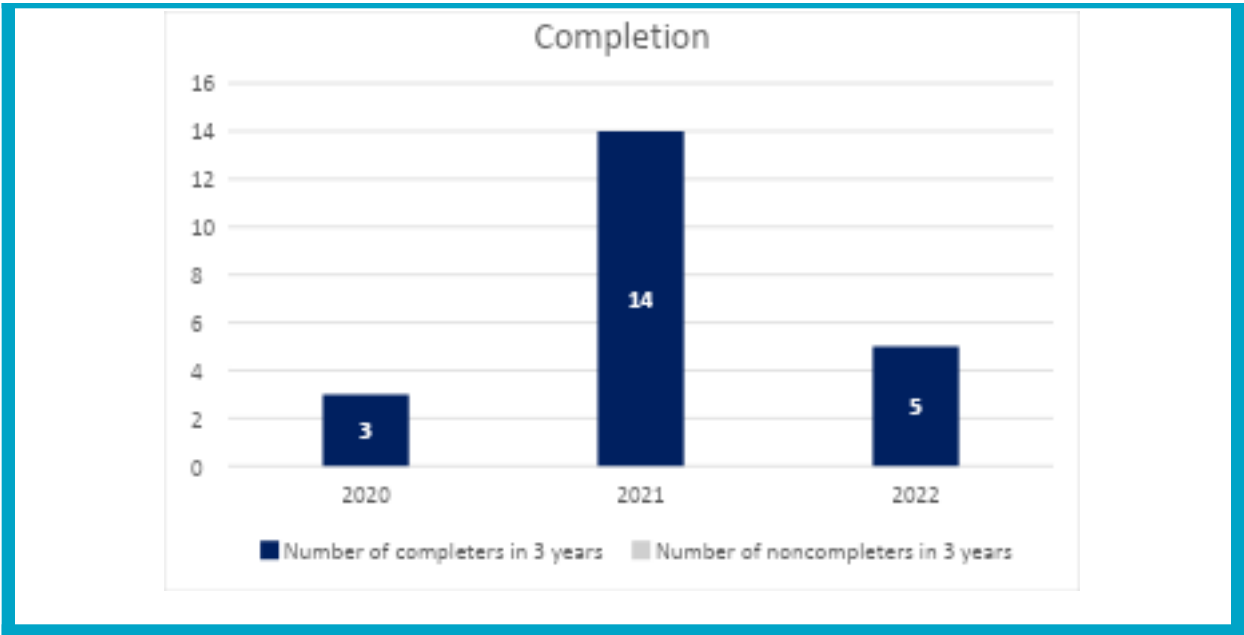
*The enrollment growth target was established with the aim of closing the sizeable gap between EPP completers and those leaving the classroom over the next 10yrs. EPPs can earn a “Meets” rating by demonstrating positive program enrollment growth (i.e., growth greater than zero) and an “Exceeds” rating by demonstrating growth greater than 10 percent.

Criteria 1.2b: Programs recruit candidates for Arkansas certification shortage areas in proportion to the need			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percent of New Enrollees in Shortage Areas	Performance Level
Percentage of program candidates recruited in shortage areas	24%	10%	BELOW



INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	74%	100%	EXCEEDS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
APPROACHING	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
University of the Ozarks provided evidence to highlight its commitment to providing candidates with the knowledge, systems and structures they need to teach in Arkansas schools, including a series of well-sequenced and varied clinical experiences and robust opportunities for candidate development. The strength of mentor teachers and clinical supervision stands out in this EPP, which builds upon the EPP/district partnerships. Candidates receive regular feedback and support that prepares them to be effective in the classroom. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - While coursework is grounded in HQIM and the state's teaching and K-12 Academic standards, University of the Ozarks course instructors could be more explicit in their instruction to integrate these standards into the EPP classroom, giving students opportunities to do things like vertically-align academic standards or modeling instructional practices like checking for understanding. (<i>Focus Area: Criteria 2.1a Metric 2, Criteria 2.1c Metric 2</i>) - University of the Ozarks should continue planning to meet the state's one-year residency requirement, which will apply to spring 2027 completers and beyond.		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction MEETS Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates nationally recognized best practices around content instruction, including recognizing and using high-quality instructional materials and evidence-based practices. In course observations, reviewers noted that course instructors incorporated best practices such as citing their sources, modeling, having teacher candidates practice different methods of reading assessments, reflecting about class activities, modifying assessments for students with accommodations, including evidence-based practices such as the phonics inventory, relating previous lessons to the current lesson, and incorporating portfolio-based activities into lessons. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants mentioned specific HQIM being utilized in the schools such as "Wonders," "Foundations," "Haggerty," and "Wit & Wisdom." The university is looking into training for the different

curricula for their faculty. The HQIM grant materials were delivered in the summer of 2024 and will be utilized by candidates as a learning tool and as a resource in their internship placements.

Internship I and II candidates are given the opportunity to observe mentor teachers working with HQIM throughout the two semesters in their placements. Internship I candidates observe, and team teach with their mentors, discuss their progress working with the learning materials and how to choose HQIM. In Internship II, teaching candidates practice using the materials in whole and small group learning.

University of the Ozarks meets the state requirements for Science of Reading awareness. Awareness is provided in Disciplinary Reading and Writing and by completing the SOR modules on Arkansas IDEAS.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development

APPROACHING

Some coursework clearly and intentionally familiarizes candidates with Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards; however, there is some inconsistency in that some syllabi references Common Core State Standards. In the Course Instructor focus group, participants said that teacher candidates triangulate their standards with the objective and assessment in their lesson plans and that they incorporate Arkansas K-12 Academic Standards in their unit plans. In the Alumni Coursework focus group, participants also mentioned that they were required to use the Standards in every lesson plan. They created a year's worth of lesson plans, and one requirement was to include the standard and explain how it correlated to the lesson. Across most of the course observations, standards were demonstrated, however not referenced explicitly.

Throughout the review, vertical integration of standards was not observed except in the Alumni Coursework focus group. There was no evidence provided in the syllabi of vertical integration of standards, and reviewers did not observe opportunities to vertically integrate standards throughout grade bands during the observations. In the Alumni Coursework focus group, graduates stated that in their courses they were split into groups, and they had to work together to see how standards aligned. They worked in other grade levels to learn about standards across their licensure areas.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses

MEETS

Courses are clearly and intentionally sequenced and increase in rigor throughout the programs of study. Course design includes checkpoints for reinforcement opportunities for candidates. All the degree plans submitted show clear progression, prerequisites, increase in rigor, and connection to clinical experience. For example, Elementary Education has an 8-semester plan, and throughout the 8-semesters coursework builds upon previous courses and rigor increases each semester.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework

MEETS

Coursework clearly and intentionally incorporates Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to meet the knowledge and skills of their required licensure area.

Of the 21 syllabi reviewed, 19 included specific reference to Arkansas Educator Competencies as well as Arkansas Teaching standards/InTASC standards. In the Handbook on page 9, it states that InTASC standards are referenced as the basis for the framework of program mission and structure, with a crosswalk showing alignment to program principles. The Observation Rubric on page 28 is aligned to TESS with cross reference to InTASC and the Intended Student Outcomes of the University. In the Internship I Syllabus, InTASC standards are listed and cross referenced with TESS and ITSE standards. Reviewers noted opportunities for reflecting on the competencies, for example, in Literary Assessment and Intervention (EDU 4063), Field Placement Reflection Journals are assigned, and students reflect upon their personal and professional experiences as they think about the topics covered in class. The assignment asks that "the student will reflect upon their deepening understanding of the Science of Reading as reflective of the Arkansas DOE Competencies for Elementary Teachers, K-6: ELA, and what participation in a PLC means to the student at this time."

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants shared that they refer to the ATS as Intended Candidate Outcomes (ICOs), and all teaching candidates have assignments in all their courses that meet those ICOs. In their portfolio teaching candidates collect evidence that they are meeting those outcomes and tie them back to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric.

In course observations, the ATS were incorporated into the activities, however, not explicitly stated. In one observation, reviewers noted that course instructors “demonstrated knowledge of the competencies and incorporated them throughout the lesson.” In another observation, the reviewer noted “the course instructor referenced Standard #6: Assessment. The teacher understands and uses multiple methods of assessment to engage learners in their own growth, to monitor learner progress, and to guide the teacher’s and learner’s decision making, and K–6 ELA 6.1: Demonstrate knowledge of formal and informal methods for assessing reading development by understanding the following: Techniques for assessing reading skills. The activity involved having teacher candidates practice an informal phonics inventory.”

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

The coursework design is clearly and intentionally aligned to clinical experience. Candidates consistently have opportunities to reflect on and articulate the alignment with their clinical supervisor and course instructors. They are given opportunities to discuss this learning through journals, reflection assignments, internship journals and post conferences. There are many examples of evidence submitted of courses with ten-hour field experience assignments, as well as courses with other connections to clinical experiences. One example is in the course Reading Eval: Individualized Assessment and Intervention Plan (Placement Case Study) (4063). In consultation with the mentor teacher for Internship I and as a member of the PLC in the host school, the candidate will select one child in the class who is a struggling reader, speller, or writer. With the mentor teacher’s guidance (and if permissible), the candidate will administer an appropriate assessment to the child, will analyze the resultant data, and will follow up by providing instruction and guidance in the diagnosed deficit skill area(s). Another example is the course, STEAM Intro (3263), where candidates develop a STEM activity for one or more of the grade levels and implement the lesson in an actual classroom while being recorded on video and under the supervision of the mentor teacher and clinical supervisor. In addition, faculty have established office hours to give students who need assistance or assurance an opportunity to meet with them throughout the week. The faculty also attend the “Teacher Table” weekly which models the importance of PLCs and networking. The “Teacher Table” is a strong example of the connection between coursework to clinical practice and experience.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of Arkansas Academic K-12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy. Two of the four instructors have a terminal degree. Seventy-five percent hold an AR teaching license. One hundred percent have had professional learning in the past year; three out of four have attended the ADE Summit 2024. Faculty members are evaluated annually, and students evaluate instructors after each course. Evaluations show that most students found the coursework useful, and the faculty evaluations meet expectations.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants shared examples of continuous learning through trainings and professional development such as RISE, LETRS, ADE Summit with SOR components, Orten Gillingham comprehensive training, substitute teaching in schools using Haggerty and Foundations, John Wick coaching training. Between all of the course observations, reviewers saw evidence of deep knowledge of Arkansas Academic K-12 standards, content knowledge, and content pedagogy.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors

APPROACHING

Reviewers observed some evidence of strong facilitation of coursework and providing feedback and support. The University of the Ozarks has a yearly evaluation process for faculty. They have a very small number of faculty in the

Pat Walker Teacher Education Program, PWTEP, and although students receive more individualized support, many times it is not documented, as it is in person and unscheduled.

In the Coursework focus group made up of alumni, participants stated that they did receive feedback and gave examples of assignments where supportive feedback was given, i.e. the assignment of the poster board for theorists and their lesson plan feedback. In the Clinical Experience focus group, participants shared that they received support and feedback from their clinical supervisor, faculty, and mentor teachers. They also stated that they received formative feedback each time they were in a classroom. Course instructors keep office hours, and in course observations it was evident across all courses that there was a supportive and caring environment that the course instructors had fostered with the teacher candidates. Almost all teacher candidates were engaged and active in every class.

Some reviewers noted that due to the smaller, informal structure of the classes, there were missed opportunities for course instructors to accurately check for understanding of content. There were a few examples observed of teacher candidates calling out answers and incorrect answers left uncorrected.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

MEETS

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall sequence of clinical experience clearly and intentionally builds off previous experiences and includes opportunities for learning and development. Teacher candidates in the PWTEP gradually build their field experiences culminating in a semester-long student teaching experience. In their third year of the program, they participate in observation activities for up to 30 hours in a semester. In their final year of the program, teacher candidates complete 90 hours of field work in their licensure area in the first semester. They observe their cooperating teacher, while also participating in daily routines and providing some instruction. In the final semester, teacher candidates spend 16 weeks in a classroom in their licensure area completing 5 phases: orientation and observation, teaching where they gradually add one subject/class per week until full-time teaching is realized, full time teaching for a minimum of two weeks, then a gradual release of teaching responsibilities back to the cooperating teacher and they complete the semester with a final week of observing. This intentional sequence to the clinical experiences was corroborated in the Clinical Supervisor focus group as well as the Clinical Experience focus group.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences

MEETS

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides adequate opportunities for candidates to work with students with varied learning needs. Teacher candidates experience multiple classrooms throughout the program including during EDU1003 where they visit three classrooms in a district, SPE2013 where they observe a SPED classroom and throughout their internship semesters. The PWTEP also works with experienced mentor teachers to set up observations in their buildings or in their district so that teacher candidates can observe multiple classroom settings. In the Clinical Experience focus group, all seven participants agreed that they had a variety of clinical experiences including having the opportunity to be in classrooms with English language learners, students with 504 or IEPs for anger and behavior issues, autism, and physical disabilities, Special Education classrooms, and Alternative Learning Environments.

In the Teacher Education Advisory Council focus group, the participants discussed how well prepared the teacher candidates are for graduation and gave the example of an assignment with a simulated student with physical accommodations (wheelchair) performance measures. Students were given an assignment where they learned how to accommodate the lesson. The group discussed the value of these types of lessons within the clinical experience in working with students of various learning needs.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Most experienced mentor teachers are equipped and demonstrate that they have the coaching skills to properly support and develop a candidate's pedagogical development. In a spreadsheet that the PWTEP provided as evidence, all nine experienced mentor teachers are rated as "effective" or "highly effective." Eight of the nine have completed a TESS or Aspiring Teacher Rubric training. There is evidence that mentor teachers use an evaluation rubric aligned with the ATR; however, no written feedback samples were shared with the reviewers to assess the effectiveness.

In the Partnership focus group, principals shared that it is a choice for teachers to mentor a teaching candidate if they have the qualifications. This is to help facilitate strong working relationships between the teacher candidate and the mentor. They also shared that experienced mentor teachers receive training from the institution and through the education service cooperative. In one of the clinical coaching observations, reviewers observed the experienced mentor teacher who gave positive feedback and opportunities for improvement. In another example, the mentor teacher affirmed that the teacher candidate was using the Capturing Kids Hearts behavioral curriculum that they had both been trained in. There was evidence observed that coaching was consistent, frequent, and built on professional trust.

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers

MEETS

Candidates are placed in field experiences with mentor teachers and faculty who are interested in the professional development of future teachers. All placements are within the state of Arkansas and ideally within a 60-mile radius of the University. Experienced mentor teachers are chosen by the building administrators. Placements happen through phone calls or personal visits to the principal to discuss the interns and what placement would strengthen the intern and their professional growth.

A clear and intentional process is in place to select experienced mentor teachers based on a set of criteria. Experienced mentor teachers are selected by their building administrators. A list of criteria must be met for a teacher to be considered a mentor teacher. They should be fully licensed in area(s) of teaching supervisory assignment, trained in the Charlotte Danielson Framework for Teaching, have at least three years of teaching experience, have a desire to work to develop the candidate as a teacher, agree to work with the clinical supervisor in planning the supervision and evaluation activities associated with the field experience, and agree to evaluate the candidate and share the evaluation with the candidate and supervisor.

The process also includes a "Cooperating Mentor Training" which covers deadlines, observation guidance and best practices for the experienced mentor teachers.

In the Partnerships focus group, four out of four principals said that they "pick the very best," and they work to make sure the mentor has time to fulfill their responsibilities. They all agreed that the process is very personalized and work hard with the EPP to set the teacher candidate and mentor up for success.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors

MEETS

Most program clinical supervisors have a proven history and show evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. There is one clinical supervisor who has 12 years of experience as a building principal and over 10 years of experience working with and observing teacher candidates. She is trained on the TESS and Aspiring Teacher Rubric. In the clinical observations the reviewers noted, the clinical supervisor shows evidence of effective instructional practices and coaching with a positive impact. The clinical supervisor had the candidate reflect on the lesson; the candidate was able to identify where she needs to improve on the lesson. The reviewers observed effective instructional practices of reflection facilitated by probing questions from the clinical supervisor.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates

MEETS

Candidates consistently receive high-quality feedback from their clinical supervisor that is frequent, both written and oral, connected to the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, clearly linked to evidence of student learning during the observed lesson, and built on the previous feedback. Candidates are trained in the Aspiring Teacher Rubric and are evaluated

using that rubric. In the "Internship I Orientation Week 1 Cooperating Teacher Training" PowerPoint, it states that the candidate will receive both oral and written feedback for each observation visit.

Feedback from both the mentor teacher and the clinical supervisor is given immediately during the post conference. Scripting is shared with the candidate at that time. The cooperating teacher also scripts and gives feedback on the observation. Post-conference on site following the observation to include cooperating mentor teacher when possible. In the clinical observations overall feedback was specific, positive, and focused on growth. The teaching candidates clearly anticipated reflections which demonstrates a pattern of feedback and reflection. An example of written feedback was submitted in the documentation.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024-25 academic year, and University of the Ozarks meets this requirement.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools

MEETS

Collaborative processes are in place with most districts and schools to co-construct the clinical internship for candidates, including but not limited to collaboration between experienced mentor teachers and clinical supervisors. In the evidence provided, the clinical supervisor and Director of the PWTEP wrote, "Prior to 2015 I was a principal in a local district and knew most of the principals in the area schools. Building a relationship and furthering the relationship is one of the top priorities of the PWTEP. We strive to help local districts by providing translators during parent/teacher conferences and many times principals will call asking if we have tutors that might be willing to tutor at the request of parents, and tutor in their after-school programs. Building administrators know that if they need anything they can call my personal number. We meet on TEAM's as they have requested online meetings due to being so busy in their buildings, in our orientation meeting we discuss programming, placements and internship requirements. I always ask for input as to what we can do better as well as what they appreciate about the program. They are pleased that upon graduation our candidates have a standard license. Teacher education advisory meetings are held in person at least once a semester. The TEAC committee is made up of stakeholders from the partnership schools who interview our Internship I students and work as advisory council for the PWTEP." In the Partnership focus group, all principals agreed that their schools have a strong relationship with the University of the Ozarks. They described the relationship as "vibrant and healthy," "phenomenal for the community," "a grow your own, raise them how we want them" collaboration. All four principals also agree that the EPP works with them individually to find teacher candidates who are a good fit, and that they are very involved in working with the EPP. For example, the principals help run mock interviews and visit the EPP to be guest speakers. They believe that teaching candidates from the PWTEP "come very prepared."

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors

MEETS

Collaborative processes are consistently in place that support and develop effective clinical supervisors. The EPP only has one clinical supervisor. The EPP gave the following examples of how the clinical supervisor continues her development: attends Deans' meetings and stays current by communicating with educational cooperative, looks for opportunities to gain knowledge through PD webinars, attended John Wick Coaching training and encourages mentor teachers to do the same, practices scripting with mentor teachers to ensure that details are not missed and enhance skills by norming with school-based support.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework

MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in coursework requirements. The EPP provided GPA to show entry and graduation GPA. The GPA remained about the same for all teacher candidates. Only two of the 27 teachers graduated with a GPA less than 3.0.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework

MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track, and they take an active role in creating the plan and monitoring progress. The PWTEP uses a Professional Growth Plan to outline programmatic expectations, and when a teacher candidate is at risk of not meeting these expectations, they are placed on an Intensive Professional Growth Plan. Together with their academic advisor and the Education department, they create an action plan and monitor progress to get back on track.

Candidates who struggle in coursework have many support services to help them. Among the program supports are student support services, tutoring labs, writing labs, 24-hour tech labs, peer groups and TRIO. The PWTEP also supports candidates as they prepare to take the Praxis test in their content area, PLT and SOR. Professional Growth Plans are implemented to help those candidates requiring extra support on focused areas after conditional admittance to the program. Candidates who struggle in their course work or with teacher dispositions at any time in the program will be placed on an intensive growth plan. The plan is created with the candidate and is monitored by the advisor and revisited at midterm and the end of the semester prior to finals. Advisors communicate through our I-CARE system to track students who need extra support. Advisors receive an email stating the candidate has been referred to an I-CARE advisor.

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship

MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

MEETS

Programs have a set of clear and appropriate goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internship, and most candidates meet them. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, the participant explained that there are five phases of the program that students complete, and each phase includes a checklist for teacher candidates to follow so that they understand the expectations.

Most candidates meet clinical experience goals and milestones by participating in various supports available to them such as optional weekly check-ins with education faculty, education clubs (Ozark Student Education Association), discussion with peers, and seminar courses now called Education Hours (professional development/training hours also occurs during this course).

The EPP states that they have a high success of job placement. For example, out of the 33 in the cohort, 27 are working in the state of Arkansas, one graduate is in graduate school, two candidates are not working in public schools, but most teaching candidates secure jobs before they leave in Internship 2.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. In the documentation submitted, candidates are required to complete an "impact on student learning project" as part of Internship II. The project is completed over several weeks and includes a pre-assessment, formative assessments, post assessment, reflections and data analysis. Licensure candidates participate in a research class where they determine a research question and find research articles to support the question which is part of the student impact. The candidates present their findings to the Education Department to be rated. In the Clinical Experience focus group, participants stated that they have to complete an assignment (student impact) that requires them to pick two students and watch for growth. This assignment gives them the opportunity to teach the class and assess student growth data.

Teacher candidates stated that they created a case study. They choose a student and identify a skill that they need support with. The teacher candidates use DIBELS to measure the student at different points throughout the semester. They stated that this information is connected to a course in their internship.

In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants shared that evidence of teacher candidates' impact on growth is demonstrated by unit plan development, reflections of their teaching, using formative assessments and identifying strategies to help students who need additional information to learn new concepts, using assessments to track and monitor growth, and attending PLC school meetings to focus on student data. In one of the Clinical observations, reviewers noted that the teaching candidate demonstrated an impact on student growth. For example, she utilized the district-wide Capturing Kids Hearts behavioral modification program. Using the "bell system" showed results with quicker behavior corrections. The mentor teacher noted that with improved behavior, more learning was achieved.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Most candidates receive a score of "effective" on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric at the end of their clinical internship or year-long residency. The "Three Year Cohort for State Audit" spreadsheet tracks Aspiring Teacher data. The data shows the scores for 30 teacher candidates. By the 6th (Final) Observation their average is 2.07. Over 80% of the cohort has a "2" or higher which means they have a score of "effective."

Note: By 2024-25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

MEETS

All candidates with varied needs are provided with the support they need, including being provided with an individualized support plan if their development in the clinical internship is not on track. The PWTEP has a very clear process in place to support teacher candidates if they are "at risk" of not meeting program expectations, including the development of an action plan and regular follow up from their advisor and the Education Department. In the Teacher Education Advisory Council focus group, participants all agreed that teacher candidates receive support. This group gave multiple examples of individual clinical internship support, including supporting a teaching candidate in the face of an alarming social media post regarding a potential school shooting. The clinical supervisor reached out to the school counselor to check on an intern who had expressed fear.

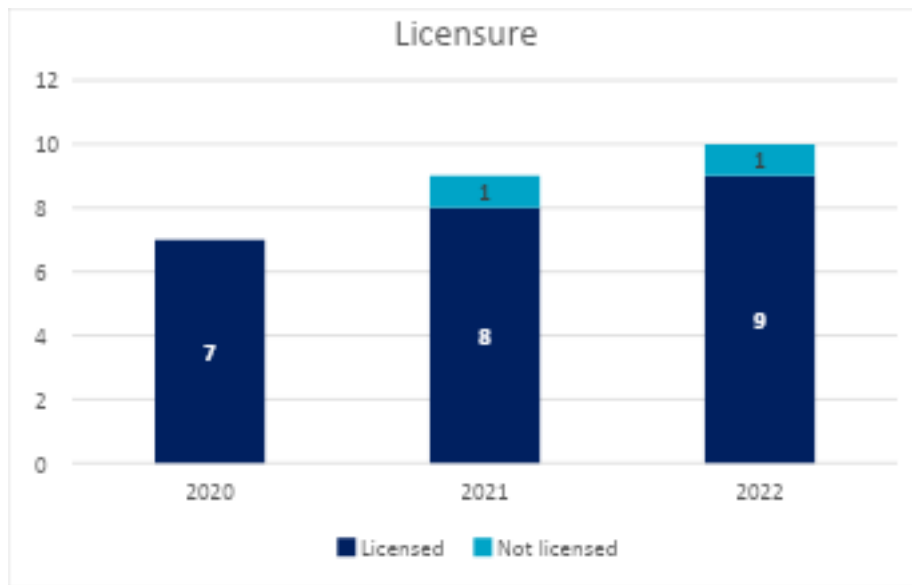
Most high performing candidates receive opportunities and feedback that encourage their retention. In the Clinical Supervisor focus group, participants shared that when high-performing teacher candidates stand out, they are chosen for leadership opportunities like presenting the introduction to the State Review team and the Science of Reading audit team. They support their peers by becoming peer tutors. They receive job offers quickly, and the EPP supports and encourages them in that process. Schools will reach out with various opportunities also. For example, one of the teacher candidates is currently coaching a kindergarten basketball team because a partner school reached out, and she was recommended. Other candidates secure long term substitute opportunities during Internship 2.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
EXCEEDS	MEETS	BELOW
Recommendations		
A high percentage of University of the Ozarks program completers go on to obtain a standard license after passing their content area exam on their first try. They also go on to gain employment in Arkansas schools. Recommendations include: - Establish programmatic support to ensure that traditional program completers are prepared to work in high-priority Arkansas schools and subjects. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.2b</i>) - Analyze EPP Completer Supervisor Survey and EPP Completer Survey results to identify specific domains and components for which both supervisors and candidates do not feel their program prepared them well to become a teacher. (<i>Focus Areas: Criteria 3.3a and 3.3b</i>)		

INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion	76%	92%	EXCEEDS

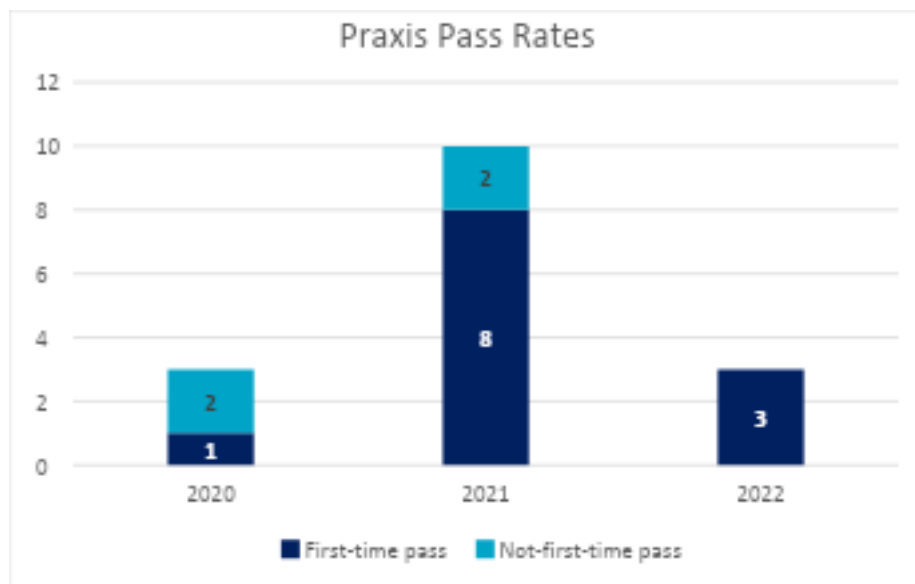


Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	69%	n/a	n/a

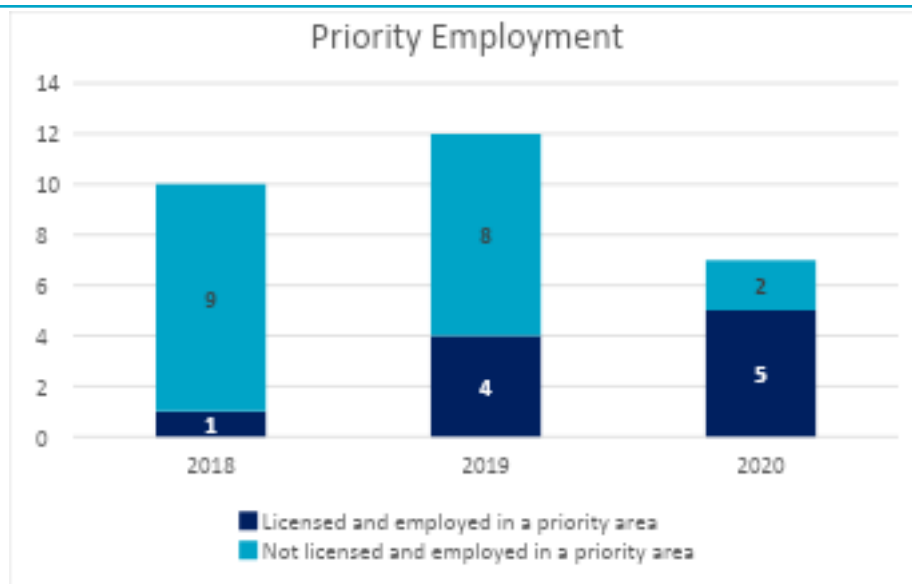
Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the Praxis content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time Praxis licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	65%	75%	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	64%	72.4%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and employed</th><th>Not licensed and employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2018</td><td>5</td><td>5</td></tr><tr><td>2019</td><td>10</td><td>2</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>6</td><td>1</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed	2018	5	5	2019	10	2	2020	6	1
Year	Licensed and employed	Not licensed and employed													
2018	5	5													
2019	10	2													
2020	6	1													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	40%	34.5%	APPROACHING												



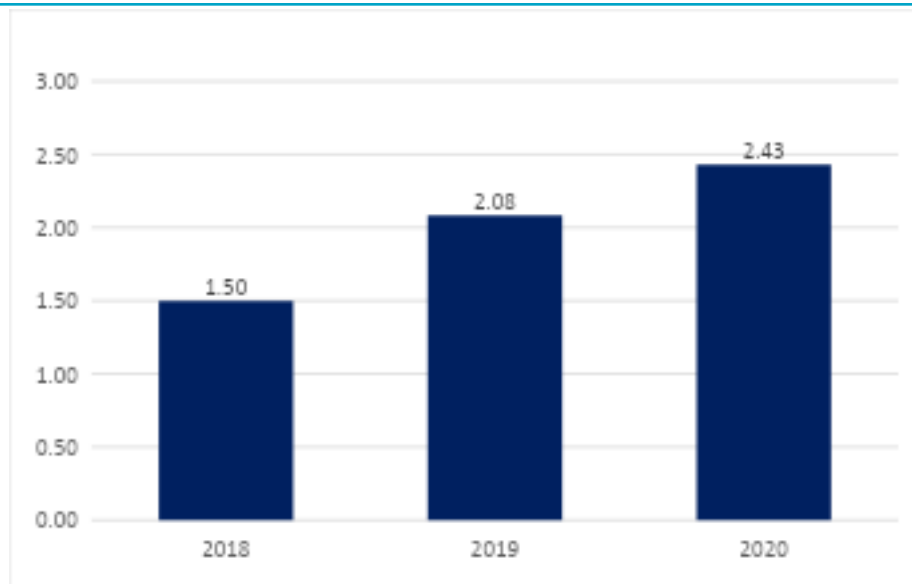
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Computer Science, Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.7	1.97	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	81%	66.7%	BELOW
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	75%	66.7%	APPROACHING
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	33.3%	APPROACHING

